

MOLLY J. DORUSKA

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EDUCATION

Cornell University

Ph.D. in Applied Economics and Management	2026
M.S. in Applied Economics and Management	2022

Lawrence University

B.A. in Economics and French and Francophone Studies, <i>summa cum laude</i>	2019
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PUBLICATIONS

Selland, E. K., Jouanard, N., Guisse, A., Seck, M., Lund, A. J., Lopez-Carr, D. Sack, A., Magblenou, L. D., De Leo, G. A., **Doruska, M. J.**, Barrett, C. B., and Rohr, J. R. (2026). Rice-fish co-culturing for schistosomiasis risk reduction and yield and income improvement. *Nature Sustainability*. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41893-026-01833-8>.

Rohr, J. R., Sack, A., Bakhoun, S., Barrett, C. B., Chamberlin, A. J., Civitello, D. J., **Doruska, M. J.**, De Leo, G. A., Forstchen, M., Haggerty, C. J. E., Jouanard, N., López-Carr, D., Lund, A. J., Ly, A. T., Seck, M., Selland, E., Sokolow, S. H., and Wolfe, C. (2025). A Planetary Health Adventure: How Removing Overgrown Water Plants Can Help Kids Stay Healthy and Improve the Planet. *Frontiers for Young Minds*. <https://doi.org/10.3389/frym.2025.1560703>.

Doruska, M. J., Barrett, C. B., and Rohr, J. R. (2024). Modeling how and why aquatic vegetation removal can free rural households from poverty-disease traps. *Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. U.S.A.* 121 (52), e2411838121. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2411838121>.

Rohr, J. R., Sack, A., Bakhoun, S., Barrett, C. B., Lopez-Carr D., Chamberlin, A. J., Civitello, D. J., Diatta, C., **Doruska, M. J.**, De Leo, G., Haggerty, C. J. E., J Jones, I. J., Jouanard, N., Lund, A. J., Ly, A. T., Ndione, R. A., Remais, J. V., Riveau, G., Schacht, A., Seck, M., Senghor, S., Sokolow, S. H., and Wolfe, C. (2023). A planetary health innovation for disease, food, and water challenges in Africa. *Nature* 619, 782-787. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-023-06313-z>.

WORKING PAPERS

Molly J. Doruska. “Coordination and Spillovers in Small-Firm Defensive Investments Against Urban Flooding”

Molly J. Doruska, Christopher B. Barrett, Samba Mbaye, and Jason R. Rohr. “Might A Market Emerge? Estimating Latent Demand and Supply for Novel Products That Improve Both Human Health and Agricultural Productivity”

Kira Lancker, Laksmi Iyer, Faraz Usmani, James Allen IV, **Molly J. Doruska**, Samba Mbaye, Amina Sylla, Binta Sow, Jason R. Rohr, and Christopher B. Barrett. “Do private incentives crowd out public good donations? Evidence from a lab-in-the-field experiment” *Submitted*.

Musa Hasen Ahmed and **Molly J. Doruska**. “Rural Road Access and Agricultural Production in Ethiopia”

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Molly J. Doruska, Brian Dillon, and Jeffrey Wall. “Changes in Surface Water Availability and Adaptation by Herders in Sub-Saharan Africa”

Christopher B. Barrett, Jason R. Rohr, Laksmi Iyer, Faraz Usmani, **Molly J. Doruska**, Nicolas Jouanard, Gilles Riveau, Samba Mbaye, Doudou Sow, Bruno Senghor, Tidjani Ly, Sidy Bakhoun, James Allen IV, and Kira Lancker. “Integrating Socio-Economic and Environmental Interventions to Improve Well-Being in Vulnerable Communities”

Emily K. Selland, Chloe Lestitian, Jean Baptiste Mansaly, Sidy Bakhoun, Bruno Piriou, **Molly J. Doruska**, Momy Seck, D. Diouf, Jonathan MacArt, Ibrahima Thiaw, Nicolas Jouanard, and Jason R. Rohr “Anaerobic co-digestion of *Ceratophyllum demersum* and cattle manure to help control schistosomiasis and invasive vegetation and improve environmental sustainability”

OTHER WRITING

Doruska, M. and Hoddinott, J. (2020) What works to reduce extreme poverty? A selective review. DEEP Working Paper 01. Data and Evidence to end Extreme Poverty Research Programme: Oxford. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.55158/DEEPWP1>.

TEACHING

Guest Lecturer, AEM 6080: Production Economics at Cornell University Fall 2025

Trip Team Leader, Field visit to Senegal for AEM 4415: Social Enterprises in Emerging Markets, Student Multidisciplinary Applied Research Teams (SMART) Program at Cornell University Winter 2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant at Cornell University

AEM 2555: Corporate Sustainability: The Business Challenge Spring 2020

AEM 4940/6940: Sustainable Business Fall 2023

AEM 2000: Contemporary Controversies in the Global Economy Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant at Lawrence University

ECON 3080: Econometrics Winter 2019

AEM 4940/6940: Sustainable Business Fall 2023

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Cornell University – Dyson School of Applied Economics & Management

Graduate Research Assistant for Christopher B. Barrett June 2020, June 2021 – May 2026

Graduate Research Assistant for John Hoddinott July 2020 – December 2020

Lawrence University

Research Assistant for Jonathan Lhost September 2018 – May 2019

GRANTS

PEDL Scale-Up Funding, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£17,328], 2025

PEDL Exploratory Research Grant, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£31,678], 2024

STEG PhD Research Travel Grant, *Flood Risk and Differential Firm Investment: Evidence from Dakar, Senegal* [£14,161], 2024

Einaudi Center for International Studies Research Travel Grant [\$1,700], 2024

Cornell University Graduate School Research Travel Grant [\$1,550], 2024

J-PAL King Climate Action Initiative, *Adaptation to Long-Term Changes in Surface Water Availability by Herders in West Africa* [\$9,600], 2023

PRESENTATIONS

2026: Y-RISE Conference 2026, CSAE Conference 2026

2025: AERE Summer Conference, College of the Holy Cross, 2025 Ecology and Evolution of Infectious Disease Conference, AAEE Annual Meeting, Camp Resources, Advances with Field Experiments, Northeast Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC)

2024: Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), AERE Summer Conference

2023: AAEE Annual Meeting

HONORS AND AWARDS

Graduate Student Research Excellence Award, Dyson School, Cornell University	2026
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Louis Pasteur Prize for Best PhD Student Paper, Advances with Field Experiments	2025
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George F. Warren Award, First Place, Cornell University for Doruska et al.	2025
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International Champion, Frontiers Planet Prize for Rohr et al.	2024
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Sustainability Science Award, The Ecological Society of America for Rohr et al.	2024
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United States National Champion, Frontiers Planet Prize for Rohr et al.	2024
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William A. McConagha Prize, Lawrence University	2019
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Iden Charles Champion Award in Commerce & Industry, Lawrence University	2019
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Philip and Rosemary Wiley Bradley Achievement Scholarship in Economics, Lawrence University	2018
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SERVICE

Referee Service, *PNAS*, *Food Policy*

Reviewer, *2025 AERE Summer Conference*, *STARS/STAARS program*

Peer Mentor, STARS/STAARS program, 2022 – 2023, 2024 – 2025

President, Applied Economics and Management Graduate Student Association, 2021 – 2022

Founder and Co-Chair, Dyson Diversity Council, 2021 – 2026

President, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2024 – 2025

Chair, Graduate Students for Gender Equity in Economics, 2023 – 2024

Vice President, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2022 – 2023

Member, Diversity in Cornell Economics, 2021 – 2026

SKILLS

Languages: English (native); French (advanced), Wolof (beginning)

Software: Stata, R, Julia, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, SurveyCTO, LaTeX, Microsoft Office Suite